Faida — Funding Readiness Roadmap

The product idea is fundable. What funders and their due diligence will push on is risk, compliance and proof of impact, more than features. This roadmap prioritises the work based on what is actually in the code, and marks what has already been done.

Status at a glance

Area	Status
Data protection — code changes	Done: consent step, PRIVACY and DELETE MY DATA commands, encrypted form answers, redacted stored values, masked logs
Data protection — organisational steps	Open: ODPC registration check, DPIA, processor agreements, retention policy, breach procedure
Official WhatsApp Business API	Open
Reliable hosting, monitoring and backups	Open — the bot currently runs on a local PC
Outcome tracking and impact dashboard	Open
Content freshness and partner agreements	Open
USSD/SMS, voice notes, revenue model	Open
Engineering basics (CI, error monitoring, IP)	Open

1. Fix what would fail due diligence

Move to the official WhatsApp Business (Cloud) API. This is the biggest risk. Baileys, the library the bot uses now, is unofficial: it logs in as a linked phone, which breaks WhatsApp's terms. The number can be banned without warning, and a reviewer will spot this immediately.

- The official API also gives a verified business profile and the green tick, which builds trust when handling people's ID numbers.
- Messages Faida starts itself (like deadline reminders) must use pre-approved templates and cost money per conversation. Budget for that.

Kenya Data Protection Act compliance. The bot collects sensitive data: ID numbers, KRA PINs, bank and M-Pesa numbers, and disability status.

- Done in code: a privacy notice and consent step before any personal question; PRIVACY and DELETE MY DATA commands; ID, KRA, bank and M-Pesa answers encrypted while a form is in progress and stored only as [redacted] afterwards; numbers masked in logs and stored chat history. See DATA_PROTECTION.pdf.
- Still open: check whether Faida must register with the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (ODPC); carry out a data protection impact assessment; sign data-processing terms with Supabase and the AI provider; set a retention policy and a breach procedure; have the notice reviewed by a lawyer and the Kiswahili checked by a native speaker.

Reliable hosting. "It runs on my PC" won't pass. Faida needs always-on hosting, uptime alerts, and database backups. Supabase's free tier has no point-in-time restore.

2. Prove impact — what funders actually fund

- **Track outcomes.** Today the funnel ends at "application completed", and nothing is submitted to the agency. Add a follow-up a few weeks later ("Did you receive the Hustler Fund loan? 1 Yes / 2 Still waiting / 3 Rejected"). Confirmed outcomes become the headline metric.
- **An impact dashboard broken down by group.** Show users reached, matches, applications and confirmed outcomes by county, gender, age band and disability. Grant makers focused on youth, women and persons with disabilities ask for exactly this. The database already has six analytics views; the dashboard just needs to display them.
- **Cost per user.** Calculate AI plus WhatsApp cost per active user. It answers "how does this scale?"

3. Trust in the content

- **Keep the catalogue fresh.** Each benefit should show a source, a "last verified" date and an owner, and the dashboard should flag stale or expired entries. An expired NRF grant was already found in the catalogue and removed; wrong information about money erodes trust fast.
- **Partner data agreements.** Formal data agreements with agencies (Hustler Fund, YEDF, county governments). A signed partnership is worth more to a funder than any feature.

4. Reach and sustainability

- **USSD/SMS fallback** (for example via Africa's Talking) for feature-phone users — a big part of the population Faida targets. The bot's turn-by-turn flow can be reused.
- **Voice notes.** The bot currently turns them away. Transcribing Kiswahili and English voice messages would help users with low literacy.
- **A revenue model.** Funders want a path beyond grants: a white-label version for SACCOs, or county governments and NGOs paying for distribution. Keep any paid placements clearly labelled, because neutrality is part of the value.

5. Engineering basics they'll check

- **Tests on every change.** Automatic test runs (for example GitHub Actions) for both apps. Recent bugs — completed applications never being saved, and the PDF command crashing — would have been caught.
- **Error monitoring** (for example Sentry) and an incident log.
- **IP and governance.** Make sure ownership of the code is clear and that every contributor has assigned their rights. The README credits "Munene", the git commits are under "Alex Gitonga", and the license is MIT.

Suggested order

1. Finish the organisational data protection steps (the code side is done).
2. Move to the official WhatsApp Business API and proper hosting.
3. Add outcome tracking and the impact dashboard.
4. Build pitch materials on those metrics.